

OT CYBERSECURITY SOFTWARE

OT Security RFP Evaluation Kit

A structured toolkit for evaluating OT and ICS security platforms. Use these four documents across the full evaluation arc: from internal preparation through vendor briefing, proof of concept, and final decision.

Document	Purpose	When to use
01 Vendor Briefing Template	Sent to vendors before demo	Before vendor conversations
02 PoC Success Criteria	Shared with vendor before PoC	Before proof of concept begins
03 Protocol & Asset Questionnaire	Internal audit + vendor response	Internal prep + RFP stage
04 Evaluation Decision Tracker	Side-by-side vendor scoring	Final decision stage

This kit is provided by OT Cybersecurity Software (otcybersecuritysoftware.com), an independent guide for OT and ICS security practitioners. We do not share your information with vendors or third parties.

Version 1.0 | June 2026

DOCUMENT 01

Vendor Briefing Template

Send this document to shortlisted vendors before any demo. Ask vendors to confirm in writing how their platform addresses each section before scheduling. A vendor who does not read your briefing has told you something.

Organization and Environment

ORGANIZATION NAME

DATE SENT

PREPARED BY

EVALUATION TIMELINE

PRIMARY CONTACT FOR VENDOR QUESTIONS

Environment Summary

Complete before sending.

INDUSTRY / SECTOR

NUMBER OF OT NETWORK SEGMENTS

APPROXIMATE KNOWN ASSET COUNT

AIR-GAPPED SEGMENTS PRESENT

☐ Yes

☐ No

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF OT ENVIRONMENT

Protocol Stack

List every industrial protocol in your environment. Vendors must confirm coverage for each.

Protocol	Equipment / Segment	Vendor must confirm coverage

Deployment Constraints

Check all that apply. Vendors must confirm compliance.

- ☐ Active scanning NOT acceptable — passive monitoring only required
- ☐ Agent installation on legacy assets NOT acceptable
- ☐ Cloud connectivity from OT network NOT permitted
- ☐ Vendor remote access to OT network NOT permitted during deployment

ADDITIONAL DEPLOYMENT CONSTRAINTS

Compliance Obligations

Check all that apply. Fill in the specific standard or subsection.

Framework	Applies	Specific standard / subsection
NERC CIP		
NERC CIP-015 (INSM — effective 2026)		
ISA/IEC 62443		
EU NIS2		
EU Cyber Resilience Act (CRA)		
TSA Security Directives		
UK NIS Regulations		
Australia SOCI Act		
Other:		
Other:		

Top Three Evaluation Criteria

Vendors should address these explicitly.

CRITERION 1

CRITERION 2

CRITERION 3

Key Questions to Ask Vendors

From the OT Security Platform Evaluation Guide. Use in vendor briefings and demos.

Protocol coverage: Walk through exactly how your platform handles [specific protocol]. What function codes do you decode, and how was that coverage validated in a production environment?

Passive deployment: If your sensor is deployed in passive-only mode with no active queries permitted, what capabilities are unavailable or degraded?

Legacy assets: What does your platform do when it encounters an asset it cannot identify or decode?

Compliance evidence: Show the exact evidence package your platform generates for a NERC CIP-015 audit. What format is it in, and has it been accepted by a NERC auditor?

Professional services: What is the minimum professional services engagement required to deploy and tune this platform in an environment like ours? What is the typical timeline?

Reference customers: Provide two reference customers in our industry who have been audited under our compliance framework and are willing to speak about their experience with your evidence package.

Vendor Response

Completed by vendor.

VENDOR NAME AND PRODUCT

PROTOCOL COVERAGE RESPONSE

DEPLOYMENT CONSTRAINTS RESPONSE**COMPLIANCE OBLIGATIONS RESPONSE****RESPONSE TO EVALUATION CRITERIA****PROFESSIONAL SERVICES REQUIREMENTS**

DOCUMENT 02

PoC Success Criteria Template

Define success criteria before the PoC begins. Share this document with the vendor. If the vendor objects to written success criteria, that is a red flag. Results are measured against these criteria at PoC conclusion.

PoC Details

VENDOR / PRODUCT	POC START DATE
POC ENVIRONMENT SEGMENT	POC END DATE
VENDOR POC LEAD	INTERNAL POC LEAD

Success Criteria

Set minimum threshold before PoC begins. Record actual results at conclusion.

Criterion	Minimum threshold (set before PoC)	Actual result (record at end)	Pass / Fail
Asset discovery completeness (% of known inventory)			
False positive rate (alerts on known-good activity during maintenance window)			
Protocol coverage (% of your protocol list detected)			
Operational impact during deployment (any disruption, however minor)			
Interface usability (end user rating)			
SIEM / SOC integration (if applicable)			
Custom criterion:			
Custom criterion:			

PoC Observations

MOST CHALLENGING ASSET TESTED AND RESULT

INTERFACE EVALUATION NOTES (FROM END USERS)

ISSUES OR CONCERNS NOTED DURING POC

Overall PoC Result

- ☐ PoC passed — all minimum thresholds met
- ☐ PoC passed with conditions — see notes below
- ☐ PoC failed — one or more thresholds not met

SUMMARY NOTES AND RECOMMENDATION

SIGNED (INTERNAL POC LEAD)

DATE

DOCUMENT 03

Protocol & Asset Questionnaire

Complete Part A internally during your environment audit. Include completed Part A when sending the Vendor Briefing Template. Vendors complete Part B. Use Part C to compare vendor responses.

Part A — Internal Environment Audit

Complete before vendor contact.

COMPLETED BY

DATE

Protocol	Equipment using it	Vendor / model	Network segment	Legacy? (Y/N)

Legacy and High-Risk Assets

Assets that cannot be patched, run agents, or require special handling.

Asset / system	OS / firmware	Protocol	Patchable? (Y/N)	Agent capable? (Y/N)

Part B — Vendor Response

Completed by vendor.

VENDOR NAME AND PRODUCT

Protocol from Part A	Supported? (Y/N)	Coverage method (passive DPI/active/both)	Function codes / versions	Validated in production? (Y/N)

PASSIVE-ONLY: FEATURES THAT REQUIRE ACTIVE QUERIES OR ARE DEGRADED

LEGACY ASSET HANDLING: PLATFORM BEHAVIOR WITH UNIDENTIFIABLE ASSETS

Part C — Comparison Notes

Internal use. Complete after all vendor responses received.

COVERAGE GAPS VS. PART A PROTOCOL LIST

EVASIVE OR INCOMPLETE VENDOR RESPONSES TO FLAG

ADDITIONAL NOTES

DOCUMENT 04

Evaluation Decision Tracker

Side-by-side vendor comparison for final decision documentation. Score each criterion 1–5. Complete after PoC and reference calls. This document serves as the audit trail for your platform decision.

Evaluation Details

PREPARED BY

DATE

EVALUATION CONTEXT (BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF PROCUREMENT DRIVER)

Vendor Shortlist

VENDOR 1

VENDOR NAME / PRODUCT

TIER

- ☐ Established
- ☐ Challenger

VENDOR 2

VENDOR NAME / PRODUCT

TIER

- ☐ Established
- ☐ Challenger

VENDOR 3

VENDOR NAME / PRODUCT

TIER

- ☐ Established
- ☐ Challenger

VENDOR 4

VENDOR NAME / PRODUCT

TIER

- ☐ Established
- ☐ Challenger

Scoring Matrix

Score each criterion 1 (poor) to 5 (excellent). Weight column optional.

Criterion	Wt.	Vendor 1	Vendor 2	Vendor 3	Vendor 4
Protocol coverage depth on your asset list					
Passive-only deployment — no active scanning					
Legacy asset handling					
Asset discovery completeness (from PoC)					
False positive rate (from PoC)					
Compliance evidence quality					
Professional services overhead (5=low)					
Support model fit for your team					
Interface usability (end user rating)					
Deployment track record in your industry					
Reference customer quality					
Total cost of ownership (yr 1 + yr 3)					
Custom criterion:					
Custom criterion:					
TOTAL SCORE					

Red Flags

Check any that apply for each vendor. A single red flag should be disqualifying.

	V1	V2	V3	V4
Will not run PoC in your environment	☐	☐	☐	☐
Passive-only claims have undocumented exceptions	☐	☐	☐	☐
Cannot provide reference customers under your compliance framework	☐	☐	☐	☐
Professional services exceeds budget, will not negotiate	☐	☐	☐	☐
Cannot explain behavior with unrecognized assets	☐	☐	☐	☐

RED FLAG NOTES

Tiebreaker Notes

When scores are close, document which factors drove the final recommendation.

TIEBREAKER ANALYSIS

Final Recommendation

RECOMMENDED VENDOR / PRODUCT

RATIONALE

CONDITIONS OR CAVEATS

CISO SIGN-OFF

PLANT MANAGER SIGN-OFF

COMPLIANCE SIGN-OFF

DATE